Getting Started With Python

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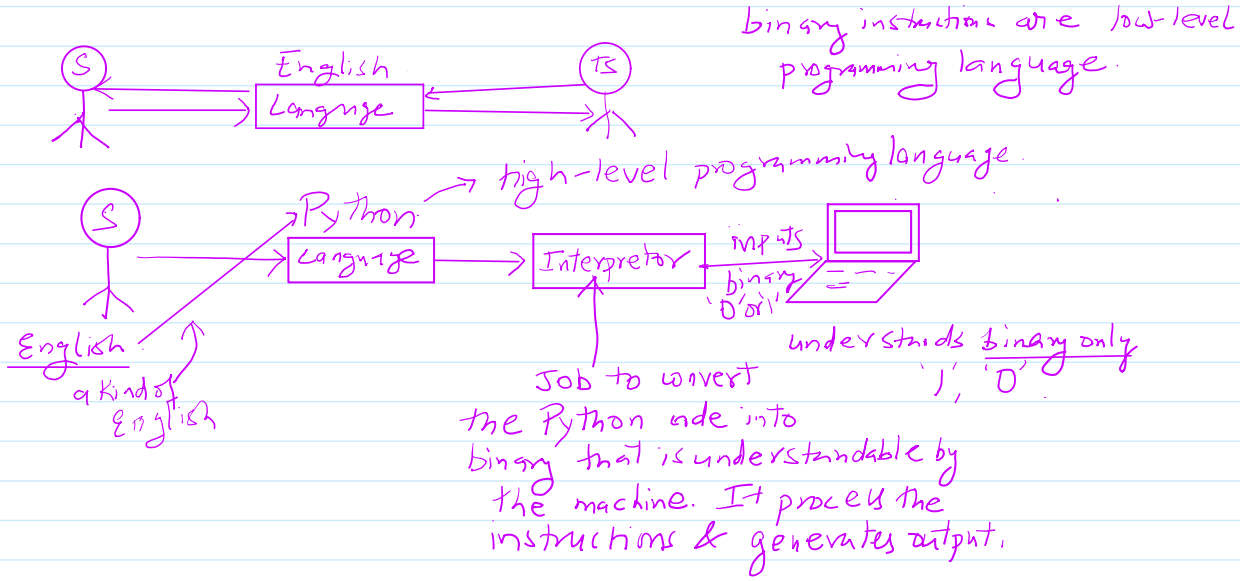
Python Programming Language.



A program written in high-level language is called source code. Python uses interpretor to convert its instructions into machine language, so that it can be understood by the computer.

Python programming language is developed by Gudio Van Rossum,

[Brief History of Python]

Python, one of the most popular programming languages today, was conceived in the late 1980s by Guido van Rossum at Centrum Wiskunde & Informatica (CWI) in the Netherlands. The initial implementation began in December 1989 as a successor to the ABC language, which van Rossum had previously worked on.

Early Development and Release

Van Rossum aimed to create a language that was more readable and easier to use than C, which he found cumbersome for certain tasks. He wanted a language that could handle exception handling and interface with the Amoeba operating system. The name "Python" was inspired by the British comedy series "Monty Python's Flying Circus," reflecting van Rossum's desire for a short, unique, and slightly mysterious name.

In February 1991, van Rossum released the first version of Python (0.9.0) to the alt.sources Usenet group. This version included features such as classes with inheritance, exception handling, functions, and core data types like list, dict, and str.

Features of Python

- Python is a high level language. It is a free and open source language.
- It is an interpreted language, as Python programs are executed by an interpreter.
- Python programs are easy to understand as they have a clearly defined syntax and relatively simple structure.
- Python is case sensitive. For example: **Number** and **number** are not same in Python.
- Python is portable and platform independent means it can run on various operating systems and hardware platform.
- Python has a rich library of pre-defined functions.
- Python is also helpful in web development. Many popular web services and applications are built using Python.
- Python uses indentation for blocks and nested blocks.

Working with Python To write and run or execute a Python, program, we need to have a Python interpreter installed on our computer or we can use any online Python. Interpreter. The interpreter is also called Python shell.

Execution Mode

There are two ways to use the Python interpreter.

1. Interactive mode
2. Script mode

Interactive mode allows execution of individual statements in instantaneously. Whereas script mode allow us to write more than one instructions in a file called Python source code file that can be executed.

1. Interactive mode:
   To work in the interactive mode, we can simply type a Python statement on the >>> prompt directly. As soon as we press enter, the interpreter executes the statement and displays the result as shown below:

Working on the interactive mode is convenient for testing a single line code for instant execution. But in interactive mode, we cannot save the statements for future use and we have to retype the statements to run them again.